

Strategies and Literature Support

Strategies Used & Literature Support

(for Section 2: Rationale — Scenario Three, Max)

1. Visual Activity Schedules / Picture Checklists

Where used: Grandma showing Max things visually at home; the picture checklist Ayoub introduces for the new Art/Music class (Scene 1, Scene 4).

Literature: van Dijk, W., & Gage, N. A. (2018). The effectiveness of visual activity schedules for individuals with intellectual disabilities: A meta-analysis. *Journal of Intellectual and Developmental Disability, 44*(4), 384–395. <https://doi.org/10.3109/13668250.2018.1431761>

Why it works / benefit: This meta-analysis of single-case design studies found that visual activity schedules produce a meaningful increase in independent, on-task behaviour for individuals with intellectual disability across a range of ages, settings and skill types. For Max, a portable, low-tech visual sequence lets him predict what happens first and next without relying on verbal instructions he may not fully process — directly supporting the ILP’s stated need for “simplified instructions, visual supports, step-by-step scaffolding.”

2. Task Analysis (Breaking Instructions into Small Steps)

Where used: SLSO 1’s suggestion of a visual checklist “so he doesn’t get thrown by too many instructions at once” (Scene 2).

Literature: Morse, T. E., & Schuster, J. W. (2000). Teaching elementary students with moderate intellectual disabilities how to shop for groceries. *Exceptional Children, 66*(2), 273–288. <https://doi.org/10.1177/001440290006600210>

Why it works / benefit: This is a foundational study demonstrating that breaking a multi-step task into smaller, sequential components (task analysis) allows students with intellectual disability to master complex tasks that would otherwise overwhelm them. Applied to Max, breaking “go to Art class” into 4–5 concrete steps reduces cognitive load and prevents the shutdown/freeze response the SLSOs describe when he’s given too many instructions at once.

3. Peer Buddy / Peer Support Arrangements

Where used: The decision to pair Max with a peer buddy for his mainstream lessons (Scene 3, Scene 4, Scene 5).

Literature: Carter, E. W., Cushing, L. S., Clark, N. M., & Kennedy, C. H. (2005). Effects of peer support interventions on students’ access to the general curriculum and social interactions. *Research and Practice for Persons with Severe Disabilities, 30*(4), 15–25.

Why it works / benefit: Carter and colleagues found that structured peer support arrangements increase both social interaction and access to the general curriculum for students with significant disabilities, and are more sustainable and less stigmatising than constant adult (SLSO) shadowing. For Max, a peer buddy addresses the social risk Grandma raises directly — “him just sitting there, on his own, and nobody noticing” — while also supporting task completion.

4. Partial Participation & Individualised Pacing (Gradual Transition)

Where used: Starting with one Art/Music lesson a week rather than full-time mainstream placement; “we go at his pace, not a set schedule” (Scene 3).

Literature: Baumgart, D., Brown, L., Pumpian, I., Nisbet, J., Ford, A., Sweet, M., Messina, R., & Schroeder, J. (1982). Principle of partial participation and individualized adaptations in educational programs for severely handicapped students. *Journal of the Association for the Severely Handicapped, 7*(2), 17–27.

Why it works / benefit: This seminal article established that students do not need to perform a skill or handle an environment independently or completely in order to benefit from participating in it — partial,

well-supported participation is legitimate and valuable in itself. This underpins the group's decision to treat mainstream inclusion as a gradual, adjustable process (one lesson a week, flexible if he needs to "stay back") rather than an all-or-nothing event.

5. Student Voice & Self-Determination

Where used: Inviting Max into the meeting and asking his preferences about class, buddy, and what to do if stuck (Scene 4).

Literature: Wehmeyer, M. L., Palmer, S. B., Agran, M., Mithaug, D. E., & Martin, J. E. (2000). Promoting causal agency: The self-determined model of instruction. *Exceptional Children*, 66(4), 439–453.

Why it works / benefit: Wehmeyer et al.'s self-determined model shows that students — including those with intellectual disability — engage more meaningfully with a plan when they have genuine opportunities for choice-making and goal-setting appropriate to their communication level. Simplifying the questions put to Max (concrete choices like "Art or Music," rather than abstract terms like "learning plan") reflects both this literature and the ILP's own communication-needs strategies.

6. Family-Professional Partnership

Where used: Grandma's presence and active voice throughout the meeting, not just as an informant but as a decision-maker (all scenes, especially Scene 2 and Scene 3).

Literature: Turnbull, A., Turnbull, H. R., Erwin, E. J., Soodak, L. C., & Shogren, K. A. (2015). *Families, professionals, and exceptionality: Positive outcomes through partnership and trust* (7th ed.). Pearson.

Why it works / benefit: The Turnbulls' research identifies trust, communication, and equality between families and professionals as key predictors of positive outcomes for students with disability. Structuring the meeting so Grandma raises concerns unprompted (rather than only answering questions) reflects genuine partnership rather than one-way reporting, and supports consistency of strategy between home and school (e.g., visual supports, modelling).

7. Modelling / Demonstration (Observational Learning)

Where used: Grandma's "I do it myself first, slowly, and he watches. Then he copies it" (Scene 1); Max copying classmates (Scene 1, Scene 2).

Literature: Bandura, A. (1977). *Social learning theory*. Prentice-Hall.

Why it works / benefit: Bandura's foundational theory of observational learning demonstrates that people, including children with learning difficulties, can acquire new behaviours by watching a model perform them before attempting the behaviour themselves. This is consistent with Max's profile (strong visual memory, learns by watching/copying peers) and supports demonstration-based teaching as a core, low-cost, home-and-school-consistent strategy.

8. Teacher-Speech Pathologist Collaboration (Interprofessional Practice)

Where used: Ayoub asking to check in with Max's speech pathologist directly (Scene 2).

Literature: Bauer, K. L., Iyer, S. N., Boon, R. T., & Fore, C. (2010). Twenty ways for classroom teachers to collaborate with speech-language pathologists. *Intervention in School and Clinic*, 45(6), 333–337. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1053451209353443>

Why it works / benefit: This literature shows that when classroom teachers and speech-language pathologists coordinate their strategies rather than working in parallel, students receive a consistent communication approach across settings, improving generalisation of communication skills. This is exactly what the ILP itself specifies: "Mrs Ayoub should work with Max's speech and language pathologist constantly."

9. Culturally & Linguistically Responsive Practice (brief, supporting note)

Where used: Grandma explaining things to Max in their home language when he struggles (Scene 2).

Literature: Baca, L. M., & Cervantes, H. T. (2004). *The bilingual special education interface* (4th ed.). Pearson/Merrill Prentice Hall.

Why it works / benefit: This is a more general, practice-based literature base rather than a single

landmark study, but it consistently supports using a student's home language alongside English to aid comprehension for culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) students with disability, rather than treating home-language use as something to discourage. This is a smaller, supporting point — useful as a brief mention rather than a major pillar of the rationale, given the less experimentally rigorous evidence base compared to strategies 1–8.

Anticipated Q&A Questions (5-minute discussion)

- 1. Why start with only one lesson a week instead of full mainstream placement?** → Grounded in the *partial participation* principle (Baumgart et al., 1982): meaningful inclusion doesn't require full independence from day one. Gradual exposure lets staff monitor Max's response and adjust before committing to more.
- 2. How did you decide on Art and Music as the first mainstream subjects?** → Strength-based placement: both are hands-on/creative areas matching Max's identified strengths (visual memory, hands-on learning), giving him the best chance of early success and confidence before tackling more demanding academic areas.
- 3. Why include a peer buddy, and how would you choose/train them?** → Based on peer support literature (Carter et al., 2005): trained peer support increases social interaction and curriculum access more effectively than constant adult shadowing, and is less stigmatising for Max.
- 4. How does the visual checklist used in the support class transfer into the new mainstream lessons?** → Visual activity schedules are portable and don't need to be "relearned" (van Dijk & Gage, 2018) — the same tool and format just moves with Max into the new environment, keeping things consistent.
- 5. How did you involve Max in decisions about his own plan?** → By simplifying choices into concrete, closed questions ("Art or Music?") rather than abstract concepts ("learning plan"), consistent with both self-determination literature (Wehmeyer et al., 2000) and the ILP's own communication strategies.
- 6. Why involve the grandmother so directly, rather than just informing her afterwards?** → Reflects family-professional partnership research (Turnbull et al., 2015): trust and two-way communication between families and schools is linked to better outcomes, and Grandma's home strategies (modelling, routines) need to align with school strategies to be effective.
- 7. What happens if the transition doesn't go smoothly — is there a contingency?** → Yes — the plan is explicitly paced to Max ("we go at his pace, not a set schedule"), and the ILP includes a Week 5 mid-point review and Week 10 final review, so adjustments are built in rather than treated as failure.
- 8. How are Max's communication needs specifically addressed?** → Through direct, ongoing collaboration between Mrs Ayoub and Max's speech pathologist (Bauer et al., 2010), ensuring the same simple-language, visual-support strategies are used consistently across settings.
- 9. How does the family's cultural and linguistic background factor into the plan?** → Max's grandmother sometimes explains things in their home language when he struggles — this is a recognised, supportive practice for CALD students with disability rather than something to discourage, and reflects respect for the family's own resources.
- 10. What underlying philosophy of inclusion is guiding your approach?** → The distinction between mere physical *integration* and genuine *inclusion* — the plan aims for real participation and belonging (peer relationships, valued roles, student voice), not just placing Max in a mainstream room.

Note: citations are provided in APA style and can be copied directly into the Rationale's reference list. If you'd like this reformatted as a Word document, just ask.